

3.3 Laser Printers

3.3.1 Fuser

After the pattern on the drum has been passed on to the paper by rolling, it passes through the fuser, where heat is applied to fuse the pigment particles to the paper.

3.3.2 Multicolour Printers

These printers have toners for each of the colours Cyan, Magenta, Yellow, and Black. In most printers, the paper passes through all the four toners in sequence, accepting each colour component to complete the print image.



A colour laser printer

3.3.3 Printer Drum

In laser printers, the drum is used to transfer the file image onto paper. The surface of the drum is charged selectively by a laser, based on the pattern to be printed. When brought in contact with the Toner, the charged areas attract the toner particles to complete the pattern on the drum. When the paper is rolled over the drum, the pattern is transferred on to it. In many entry level models, the Drum and Fuser are combined with the toner hopper, so when the toner is depleted all the components have to be discarded.

3.3.4 Toner

This refers to the fine electrostatically charged powder that is used as the medium in a laser printer. It consists of minute particles of pigment and plastic. Monochrome printers have just a black toner. Multi colour printers have toners for each of the colours Cyan, Magenta and Yellow (besides black). The toner is packed into a receptacle called the Toner Hopper.